



HM Revenue
& Customs

Guidance

Rates and allowances: National Insurance contributions

Updated 22 July 2024

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There are different [‘classes’ of National Insurance \(NI\)](https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/national-insurance/national-insurance-classes) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/national-insurance/national-insurance-classes>). The type people pay depends on their employment status and how much they earn.

New National Insurance bands and allowances are usually announced in the Chancellor of the Exchequer’s Budget or Autumn Statement.

1. Class 1 National Insurance thresholds

Employers and employees pay Class 1 National Insurance depending on how much the employee earns. You can view these earnings thresholds by week (table 1.1) or by month (table 1.2).

1.1 Weekly thresholds

£ per week	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023	6 April 2022 to 5 July 2022	2021 to 2022
Lower Earnings Limit (LEL) Employees do not pay National Insurance but get the benefits of paying	£123	£123	£123	£123	£120
Primary Threshold (PT) Employees start paying National Insurance	£242	£242	£242	£190	£184
Secondary Threshold (ST) Employers start paying National Insurance	£175	£175	£175	£175	£170
Upper Earnings Limit (UEL) All employees pay a lower rate of National	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967

£ per week	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023	6 April 2022 to 5 July 2022	2021 to 2022
Insurance above this point					
Upper Secondary Threshold (UST) Employers of employees who are under 21 pay zero rate up to this point	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967
Apprentice Upper Secondary Threshold (AUST) Employers of certain apprentices who are under 25 pay zero rate up to this point	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967
Freeports Upper Secondary Threshold (FUST) Employers of eligible employees working in a freeport special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£481	£481	£481	£481	N/A
Investment Zones Upper Secondary Threshold (IZUST) Employers of eligible employees working in an investment zone special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£481	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Veterans Upper Secondary Threshold (VUST) Employers of qualifying employees pay zero rate up to this point	£967	£967	£967	£967	£967

1.2 Monthly thresholds

£ per month	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023	6 April 2022 to 5 July 2022	2021 to 2022
Lower Earnings Limit (LEL) Employees do not pay National Insurance but get the benefits of paying	£533	£533	£533	£533	£520
Primary Threshold (PT) Employees start paying National Insurance	£1,048	£1,048	£1,048	£823	£797
Secondary Threshold (ST) Employers start paying National Insurance	£758	£758	£758	£758	£737
Upper Earnings Limit (UEL) All employees pay a lower rate of National Insurance above this point	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189
Upper Secondary Threshold (UST) Employers of employees who are under 21 pay zero rate up to this point	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189
Apprentice Upper Secondary Threshold (AUST) Employers of certain apprentices	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189

£ per month	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	6 July 2022 to 5 April 2023	6 April 2022 to 5 July 2022	2021 to 2022
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who are under 25
pay zero rate
up to this point

Freeports Upper Secondary Threshold (FUST) Employers of eligible employees working in a freeport special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£2,083	£2,083	£2,083	£2,083	N/A
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Investment Zones Upper Secondary Threshold (IZUST) Employers of eligible employees working in an investment zone special tax site pay zero rate up to this point	£2,083	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
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Veterans Upper Secondary Threshold (VUST) Employers of qualifying employees pay zero rate up to this point	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189	£4,189
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2. Class 1 National Insurance rates

2.1 Employer rates

This table shows how much employers pay towards their employees' National Insurance.

Percentage rate	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	From 6 November 2022 to 5 April 2023	From 6 April 2022 to 5 November 2022	2021 to 2022
Rate above the Secondary Threshold	13.8%	13.8%	13.8%	15.05%	13.8%
Rate below Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	N/A
Rate below Freeports Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	N/A
Rate below Apprentice Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	N/A
Rate below Investment Zones Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Rate below Veterans Upper Secondary Threshold	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Class 1A rate on expenses and benefits	13.8%	13.8%	14.53%	15.05%	13.8%

The rate shown in the second column of the table (from 6 November 2022) is the Class 1A rate that applies to the whole tax year because

Class 1A is an annualised charge.

Read CWG5 for the [rates that apply to termination awards and sporting testimonials paid through real time information](https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/cwg5-class-1a-national-insurance-contributions-on-benefits-in-kind) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/cwg5-class-1a-national-insurance-contributions-on-benefits-in-kind>).

2.2 Employee rates

This table shows how much employers deduct from employees’ pay.

Percentage rate	2024 to 2025	From 6 January 2024 to 5 April 2024	From 6 April 2023 to 5 January 2024	From 6 November 2022 to 5 April 2023	From 6 April 2022 to 5 November 2022	202 to 202
Between Primary Threshold and Upper Earnings Limit	8%	10%	12%	12%	13.25%	12%
Above Upper Earnings Limit	2%	2%	2%	2%	3.25%	2%
Married women’s reduced rate between primary threshold and upper earnings limit	1.85%	3.85%	5.85%	5.85%	7.1%	5.8%
Rate for employees deferring	2%	2%	2%	2%	3.25%	2%

Percentage rate	2024 to 2025	From 6 January 2024 to 5 April 2024	From 6 April 2023 to 5 January 2024	From 6 November 2022 to 5 April 2023	From 6 April 2022 to 5 November 2022	202 to 202
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[National](#)

For 2023 to 2024 and 2022 to 2023, the National Insurance contributions rates for directors are different. Read CA44 to find out more about [rates for directors](#) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/ca44-national-insurance-for-company-directors>).

3. Class 2 and Class 4 National Insurance (self-employed)

There are 2 types of National Insurance for people who [work for themselves](#) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/working-for-yourself>), depending on their profits.

3.1 Class 2

Thresholds	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	2022 to 2023	2021 to 2022
Small Profits Threshold amount per year	£6,725	£6,725	£6,725	£6,515
Rate per week	£3.45	£3.45	£3.15	£3.05

3.2 Class 4

£ per year	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	2022 to 2023	2021 to 2022
Lower Profits Limit Self-employed people pay Class 4 National Insurance on profits above the Lower Profits Limit	£12,570	£12,570	£11,908	£9,568
Upper Profits Limit Self-employed people pay a lower rate of Class 4 National Insurance on profits above the Upper Profits Limit	£50,270	£50,270	£50,270	£50,270
Rate between Lower Profits Limit to the Upper Profits Limit	6%	9%	9.73%	9%
Rate above Upper Profits Limit	2%	2%	2.73%	2%

3.3 Special rates

£ per week	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	2022 to 2023	2021 to 2022
Special Class 2 rate for share fishermen	£4.10	£4.10	£3.80	£3.70
Special Class 2 rate for volunteer development workers	£6.15	£6.15	£6.15	£6
Additional Class 4 rate when deferring National Insurance	2%	2%	2.73%	2%

4. Class 3 National Insurance (voluntary)

You can pay [voluntary National Insurance](https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/voluntary-national-insurance-contributions) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/voluntary-national-insurance-contributions>) to fill or avoid gaps in your record.

If you’re paying voluntary contributions for the previous 2 tax years (2023 to 2024 or 2022 to 2023), you’ll pay the original rates for those years.

For all other years you’ll pay the current rate (2024 to 2025).

£ per week	2024 to 2025	2023 to 2024	2022 to 2023	2021 to 2022
Class 3 rate	£17.45	£17.45	£15.85	£15.40

Monthly Direct Debit payments for 2024 to 2025

How much you pay depends on whether there are 4 or 5 weeks in the month.

Payment date	Amount
10 May 2024	£87.25
14 June 2024	£69.80
12 July 2024	£69.80
9 August 2024	£87.25
13 September 2024	£69.80
11 October 2024	£69.80
8 November 2024	£87.25
13 December 2024	£69.80
10 January 2025	£87.25
14 February 2025	£69.80
14 March 2025	£69.80
11 April 2025	£69.80

5. Historical and future rates

You can view [National Insurance rates and thresholds for previous tax years](https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/main-features-of-national-insurance-contributions) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/main-features-of-national-insurance-contributions>).

There will be some [new National Insurance rates and thresholds](https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/guidance/rates-and-thresholds-for-employers-2024-to-2025) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/guidance/rates-and-thresholds-for-employers-2024-to-2025>) from 6 April 2024.

6. Income Tax rates

You can see [Income Tax rates](https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/income-tax-rates) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250201135714/https://www.gov.uk/income-tax-rates>) for the current and previous tax years.



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